

Contacts to new editors. Bylines in prestigious publications so I could get my next byline in the next prestigious publication.

It was about the optics of appearing successful. The money was the part no one saw, so who cared what I was getting paid? Some of these places, I would have skinned myself and paid them in my own flesh to be able to write for them.

The question embarrassed me because often I was so excited about being published that I didn't want to mar the occasion by talking payment. I'd sometimes forget to ask the publications. I found it to be a huge buzzkill. But if my dad eventually wanted to ask me about what I was being paid later on in the conversation? I shouldn't have been so hardline about it. The truth is that I was embarrassed I hadn't even thought about it.

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So how *do* you navigate spending and saving in college? Admissions consultant Anna Ivey said she worries that more and more students are picking colleges based on fun and amenities rather than education—and this results in overspending on drinking, Greek life, and other socializing with new, exciting friends. That's not to say you should hole up in your dorm and never hang out, just that that's not all college is about. And being too into that aspect can lead to poor finances at a time when you're already spending on textbooks, extracurriculars, and dorm furnishings, let's say. Though for textbooks, I imagine that if you're a college student, you've already figured out that you don't need to get them all before class begins and that you don't need to get them new or from anywhere other than the library. I can't tell you how many times a professor insisted we get a textbook, only for us never to use it. I also had roommates who were older than me and in the same major, so I got a lot of hand-me-downs. (I even wore my ex-girlfriend's old graduation robe.)

Studies show the majority of college students work part-time during school, and most of them work in the service industry. (A 2013 survey in *Seventeen* magazine said American students average nineteen hours of work a week on top of school, and most don't make enough to pay any of their tuition, relying still on student loans and scholarships.) Finding a job in college can be similar to